BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

White-Label, Multi-Tenant Salon Management SaaS

Branded customer booking apps for iOS and Android, a salon workspace on the web, and the platform that runs every salon as a tenant on one codebase and one database.

VERSION	DATE	LAUNCH MARKET	BASIS
1.0 · Draft for review	11 October 2026	Sri Lanka (LKR)	Prototype review + market and technical research

Document control

Item	Detail
Document	Business Requirements Document (BRD) for the salon management SaaS platform
Version / status	1.0, draft for product owner review. Nothing in this document is approved until the open decisions in section 14 are closed.
Purpose	Define what the business needs the platform to do, why, and in what order, so that design, architecture and delivery planning can start from an agreed baseline.
Inputs	(1) The interactive HTML prototype `index.html` and its `brand.json`, read in full. (2) Research carried out in October 2026 into competing salon software, app store policy, multi-tenant architecture practice and the Sri Lankan payments, messaging and data-protection environment. Sources are listed in Appendix A.
Audience	Product owner, solution architect, UX designer, engineering leads, QA lead, commercial and onboarding staff.
Working name	The prototype refers to “COSMO” and the domain `cosmo.lk`. This document says “the platform” throughout; the product name is an open decision (D-02).
Out of this document	Detailed UI specifications, API contracts, data model DDL and test cases. These follow from this BRD in the functional specification and solution design.

How to read the requirement tables

Every functional requirement in section 8 carries three markers.

Must the release is not viable without it **Should** important, but a workaround exists **Could** valuable when capacity allows

R1 first release (MVP) **R2** second release **R3** later ● Yes: already shown in the prototype

◐ Partial: shown but incomplete or hard-coded ○ New: not in the prototype

Research figures quoted from software vendors are marked as vendor-reported. They are directional evidence, not independent measurements.

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1. Executive summary

The business wants to sell salons their own booking app and their own management system, while operating a single product: one React Native codebase released as many branded apps, one Spring Boot backend, one PostgreSQL database, and one Next.js web application, with every salon isolated as a tenant.

The prototype is a strong start. Its booking core (availability, ten-minute slot holds, deposits, payment failure handling, reschedule and cancel, walk-in queue, drag-and-drop calendar) is more carefully thought through than many shipping products. What it shows, though, is one salon. The platform that makes it a SaaS business is not in it yet, and one part of the intended distribution plan conflicts with app store rules. The six findings below shape everything else in this document.

1.1 Key findings

#	Finding	What it means
1	**The app store plan needs to change.** Apple's guideline 4.2.6 rejects apps built from a template unless they are "submitted directly by the provider of the app's content", and guideline 4.3(a) forbids multiple bundle IDs of the same app. Google advises white-label developers against putting all client apps in one developer account.	The operator cannot publish every salon's app from its own developer accounts. Each salon that wants a dedicated store app needs its own Apple and Google developer accounts, with the operator added as a delegated admin who builds and uploads. This is how Phorest, Mindbody and Pike13 already deliver branded apps. See section 7.4.
2	**A three-layer mobile offer fits the market better than "an app for everyone".** Organisation enrolment with Apple needs a registered legal entity, a D-U-N-S number and a public website. Many small salons will not clear that bar quickly.	Give every salon a branded booking site and a place inside one shared container app from day one (both allowed and instant). Sell the dedicated store app as a premium upgrade from the same codebase.
3	**The prototype is single-salon.** There is no tenant onboarding, subscription billing, operator console, roles and permissions, customer accounts, configurable policies, real staff rotas or multi-branch support.	These are the largest block of new requirements (sections 8.1, 8.2, 8.4). They are prerequisites for selling to a second salon.
4	**Shared database with a tenant column, enforced by PostgreSQL row-level security, is the right tenancy model.** Schema-per-tenant multiplies migration and operations work as salons are added, with no benefit this product needs.	One schema, `tenant_id` on every tenant-owned table, isolation enforced twice: in the application (Hibernate `@TenantId`) and in the database (RLS). See section 7.2.
5	**The global leader already sells in rupees.** Fresha lists Sri Lankan pricing at LKR 1,790 a month for an independent and LKR 1,190 per team member a month for teams, plus paid add-ons and a marketplace fee on new clients.	Competing on price alone is not a strategy. The defensible position is brand ownership (the salon's own app and domain, no marketplace, no commission), local payments, WhatsApp-first messaging, and Sinhala and Tamil.
6	**Money should settle directly to the salon.** There is no Stripe Connect equivalent to lean on locally, and holding customer funds on behalf of salons raises licensing questions.	Each salon connects its own payment gateway merchant account (PayHere first). The platform orchestrates payments and never holds booking funds. See section 7.7.

1.2 Recommended approach in one paragraph

Build a modular monolith on Spring Boot 4.1 and Java 25 with virtual threads enabled, backed by a single PostgreSQL database using a shared schema with row-level security. Serve three web surfaces from one Next.js application, routed by hostname: the salon's public booking site, the salon workspace, and the operator console. Build the customer app

once in React Native with Expo; inject only identity (name, icon, bundle ID, tenant key) at build time and load all other branding from the API at run time, so a colour change never needs a store release. Automate per-tenant builds and submissions. Release in three steps: an MVP that lets a salon take bookings and run its day, a second release that adds retention and marketing tools, and a third that adds retail, payroll and conversational booking.

1.3 Decisions needed before design starts

Ref	Decision	Recommendation
D-01	How are customer apps distributed?	Hybrid: booking site and shared container app for all, dedicated store app as a premium tier under the salon's own developer accounts.
D-03	Who collects booking payments?	The salon, through its own merchant account. The platform bills the salon separately for its subscription.
D-04	Is a customer one identity across all salons, or one per salon?	One per salon. It matches the "your own app" promise and keeps each salon's customer list private.
D-06	Pricing and packaging	Three tiers with flat pricing per location by staff band, benchmarked in section 11.
D-09	Languages at launch	English at launch with the app fully translation-ready; Sinhala and Tamil in the second release.

The full list of thirteen open decisions is in section 14.

2. Business context and objectives

2.1 Background and problem

Most salons in the launch market still take bookings by phone call, WhatsApp message and walk-in, and record them on paper or in a chat thread. The consequences are familiar: bookings arrive while staff are busy with clients or after closing, double bookings happen, no-shows cost a chair for an hour, and the owner has no reliable view of revenue or of which customers have stopped coming.

Software that solves this exists, but the dominant products are marketplaces. They list the salon beside its competitors, charge a commission on new clients, and build the marketplace's brand in the customer's phone rather than the salon's. Salons that want an app under their own name are offered it only by enterprise-priced products.

2.2 Vision

> Give every salon, including a three-chair business, booking and management tools under its own brand: its own app in the customer's phone, its own web address, its own customer list. Run all of it as one product so that it stays affordable to sell and to operate.

2.3 Business objectives and success measures

Targets are proposals for the product owner to confirm; the measurement method matters more than the starting number.

Ref	Objective	Measure	Proposed target
BO-1	Make a new salon bookable quickly	Time from signed contract to first online booking on the salon's branded site	Under 1 working day
BO-2	Deliver dedicated store apps predictably	Time from the salon's developer accounts being ready to both apps live	Under 10 working days
BO-3	Move bookings online	Share of a salon's appointments created by the customer (app, site, link) after 90 days	40% or more
BO-4	Reduce no-shows	No-show rate before and after go-live, measured per salon	30% reduction at 90 days
BO-5	Keep salons	Monthly logo churn after the first three months	Under 2%
BO-6	Keep operating cost flat per salon	Operator hours per salon per month (support, releases, billing)	Falling quarter on quarter
BO-7	Protect tenant data	Cross-tenant data exposure incidents	Zero, verified by automated isolation tests and an annual penetration test
BO-8	Be dependable in opening hours	Availability of booking and calendar functions	99.9% monthly

2.4 Scope

In scope

- Customer booking experience on iOS, Android and the web, branded per salon
- Salon workspace for owners, managers, reception and professionals (responsive web)
- Operator console: tenants, plans, billing, releases, support
- Booking engine, payments and refunds, notifications, customer records, reports
- White-label build and release pipeline for the apps
- Tenant web addresses: platform subdomain and salon-owned domain
- Retention tools: reviews, loyalty, campaigns, packages (later releases)

Out of scope for now

- A consumer marketplace or directory listing salons against each other. It contradicts the positioning; revisit only as an explicit strategy change (D-12)
- Full accounting, payroll processing and statutory filings (reports and exports only)
- Card-present payment terminals integrated in software (record the tender type instead)
- A native app for staff (the responsive workspace covers R1; revisit in D-11)
- Medical-grade clinical records for aesthetic clinics
- Markets outside Sri Lanka, although currency, time zone, language and tax are configurable per tenant from the start

2.5 The product at a glance

Surface	Who uses it	Technology	In prototype
Customer app	Salon customers	React Native (Expo), one codebase, many branded builds	Yes, as a mobile web mock-up
Branded booking site	Customers who have not installed the app; people arriving from Instagram, Google or a WhatsApp link	Next.js on the salon’s domain	Same screens serve as the model
Salon workspace	Owner, manager, receptionist, professional	Next.js, responsive from phone to desktop	Yes
Operator console	The platform business: onboarding, billing, support, releases	Next.js	No
Backend API	All of the above	Spring Boot 4.1, Java 25, virtual threads, PostgreSQL	No (the prototype holds data in the browser)

3. Stakeholders and users

Role	Goals	Frustrations today	What the platform must give them
Platform owner (the business)	Recurring revenue from many salons with a small team	Each new customer threatens to add bespoke work	One codebase, configuration instead of customisation, automated releases, clear unit costs
Onboarding and support staff	Take a salon live quickly; resolve issues without engineers	Manual setup, no visibility into what the salon sees	Onboarding wizard, data import, controlled and logged support access, tenant health view
Salon owner	Full chairs, fewer no-shows, loyal customers, a brand that looks established	Phone tag, marketplace commissions, surprise fees, no clear numbers	Own-brand app and site, deposits, reminders, honest pricing, daily and monthly figures
Manager / receptionist	A calm, accurate day	Double bookings, walk-ins colliding with appointments, chasing customers by phone	One calendar, walk-in queue, conflict warnings, one-tap contact, quick checkout
Professional (stylist, therapist, nail artist)	Know the day ahead, keep regulars, be paid fairly	Last-minute changes they hear about late	Own schedule on the phone, customer notes and formulas, visible performance
Customer, new	Book quickly without a phone call, know the price and the time	Waiting for a reply, unclear prices, having to create yet another account	Booking in under two minutes, clear price and duration, guest or OTP sign-in, instant confirmation
Customer, returning	Get the usual with the usual person	Repeating details every time	Rebook in one tap, reminders, loyalty rewards, easy reschedule
External parties	n/a	n/a	Apple and Google (store policy), payment gateway, WhatsApp and SMS providers, the Data Protection Authority: each imposes rules reflected in sections 7 and 10

4. Current state: what the prototype defines

The prototype is a single HTML page with two modes, **Customer** and **Salon**, switched by a toggle in the header (a demonstration device, not a product feature). Data lives in the browser. Branding is read from `brand.json`. The content is Sri Lankan: prices in rupees, `+94` mobile numbers, a Colombo address.

4.1 Customer experience

Screen	What it does
Home	Cover image, logo, salon name, location, rating, open status and hours. Primary action “Book an appointment”; shortcuts to Services, WhatsApp and Call. Popular services with price and duration. A “Your next appointment” card once a booking exists.
Services	Search and category filter (All, Hair, Nails, Facial, Makeup, Spa). Multi-select with a running total of price and minutes.
Step 1 of 5: Services	Same list inside the booking flow, with a summary of total duration and price when more than one service is chosen.
Step 2: Professional	“Any available professional” (default) or a named professional. Only people able to perform every chosen service are listed, each with role, rating, specialities and number of free times today. If nobody can do all services, the customer is told to remove one or book two visits.
Step 3: Time	Six-day strip with a coloured state per day (Open, Limited, Full, Closed). Slots every 30 minutes that fit the whole appointment including buffer. Slots held by another customer show as “Held”. Choosing a slot reserves it for 10 minutes with a visible countdown. If nothing is free: next available day, Join waitlist, Contact salon.
Step 4: Details	Name, Sri Lankan mobile number (validated), optional email and notes. “No account needed.” A returning number triggers “Welcome back” with an offer to reuse details.
Step 5: Pay to confirm	Summary, then a choice of deposit, full payment or pay at salon. Handles processing, failure, customer cancellation, and “verification in progress” when the bank has not answered (with an explicit instruction not to pay again). Going offline mid-payment is handled.
Confirmation	Booking ID, summary, amount paid and balance due, notice that WhatsApp and SMS confirmations were sent, Add to calendar, Contact salon, Manage, and an offer to save details.
My booking	Status and payment badges, Reschedule (availability is checked again on confirm), Cancel (policy and refund amount shown first), Contact salon.
Waitlist	Date, time band, professional and service. The customer is messaged when a time opens and must confirm before anything is booked.
Contact	Address, hours, phone, WhatsApp and Call actions.

4.2 Salon workspace

Area	What it does
Today	Four figures (appointments, collected, to collect at salon, walk-in queue). Schedule as a timeline per professional, a list, or a week view with occupancy. Timeline shows breaks, the current time, leave, holds in progress, and status colours. Confirmed bookings can be dragged to another time or professional; a move is rejected with a reason if it leaves opening hours, hits a break, leave, a hold or another booking, lands in the past, or the professional does not offer the service. Side panels: who is available now, walk-in queue, waitlist. A banner lists bookings that need attention.
Bookings	Searchable table (name, phone, booking ID) with day and status filters. Columns: when, customer, service, professional, payment, status, source.

Area	What it does
Booking detail	Status actions (confirm, mark arrived, mark completed, cancel, no-show), reschedule to a free time with the same professional, contact, refund.
Walk-ins	Capture name, phone, service and preferred professional; check availability now. Either start immediately, book the next free time, or join the queue with an estimated wait. Confirmed bookings are never moved to make room.
Customers	List built from bookings: visits, upcoming appointment, preferred professional, total paid, no-shows. Detail shows history, with Book, Contact and Add note.
Reports	Today, 7 days, 30 days or a custom range, with comparison to the previous period. Appointments, revenue, collected, outstanding, revenue by day, completed / no-show / cancelled, average per booking, booking sources, top services, staff totals, day-by-day table, CSV download.
Staff	Per person: hours, break, services, and a toggle to add leave. A toggle to close the salon for a day. Affected bookings are kept and flagged, never removed.
Services	Edit price, minutes and buffer per service. Changing duration recalculates future availability.
Payments	Every booking with total, paid, balance, payment state and refund state. Failed refunds can be retried or escalated; processing refunds can be marked refunded.
WhatsApp	A concept preview: a customer asks for a time in chat, the salon offers slots, a secure booking link (held for 10 minutes) completes the booking.
Settings	Salon name, tagline, logo, cover photo and brand colour with a live preview. Changes are private until Publish. Text colour on the brand colour adjusts automatically for contrast.
Notifications	A sample list of the messages the product sends and their channels.

4.3 Business rules found in the prototype

These rules are implemented in the prototype's logic. The right-hand column states how each should be treated in the product.

Ref	Rule as prototyped	Treatment in the product
BR-01	Opening hours 9:00 to 18:00, Monday to Saturday; one shared break 13:00 to 14:00 for all staff.	Configurable per salon, per branch and per professional, with date overrides and public holidays.
BR-02	Appointment length is the sum of each service's duration plus its buffer. Customers see service minutes; the buffer is added silently.	Keep. Buffer stays an internal scheduling concept.
BR-03	Customer slots start every 30 minutes; staff actions snap to 15 minutes.	Keep the distinction; make both intervals configurable.
BR-04	Today's first slot is the next 30-minute boundary after the current time.	Replace with a configurable minimum notice (for example 60 minutes).
BR-05	A professional is eligible only if their skills cover every chosen service category.	Keep, but match on services rather than categories, and offer a multi-professional sequence when no single person qualifies.
BR-06	"Any professional" assigns the first eligible person who is free.	Keep, with a choice of assignment strategy (first free, balance workload, seniority).
BR-07	A slot is unavailable if it overlaps a break, leave, a live booking, or a hold by another customer.	Keep. Add resource limits (chair, room) in a later release.
BR-08	A day is Limited when three or fewer slots remain, Full when none remain, Closed on a closed day.	Keep.

Ref	Rule as prototyped	Treatment in the product
BR-09	Choosing a slot holds it for 10 minutes. The hold is shown to staff, is not released while a payment is processing, and becomes a booking only if payment succeeds (or the customer chooses pay at salon).	Keep. Hold length configurable. Enforce at the database so two customers cannot hold the same time.
BR-10	Deposit is 20% of the total, rounded to the nearest Rs. 100, capped at Rs. 2,000.	Make configurable: percentage or fixed amount, cap, and per-service override (for example a higher deposit for bridal).
BR-11	Three payment choices: deposit, full, pay at salon.	Keep. Each can be switched off per salon or per service.
BR-12	Payment results: success; failed (no money taken, slot still held); cancelled by customer; verification pending (do not pay again, check status). Completing twice never creates two bookings.	Keep. The server decides the result from the gateway's signed callback.
BR-13	Cancellation is free up to 24 hours before; later, the deposit is kept. Refunds take 3 to 5 working days.	Make the window and the retained amount configurable. Show the calculated refund before the customer confirms.
BR-14	Refund states: processing, refunded, failed (retry or contact support).	Keep.
BR-15	Reschedule keeps the same professional and re-checks availability at the moment of confirmation.	Keep; allow changing professional. Add a limit on how late and how often.
BR-16	Walk-ins never displace confirmed bookings; the system offers "now", "next available" or the queue with an estimated wait.	Keep.
BR-17	Adding leave or closing a day keeps existing bookings and flags them for staff action.	Keep. Nothing is ever cancelled automatically without a person deciding.
BR-18	Statuses: pending, confirmed, arrived, completed, cancelled, no-show. No-shows are recorded on the customer.	Keep; add "in service" and a reason for cancellations.
BR-19	Booking sources: Online, WhatsApp, Walk-in, Phone.	Keep; add App, Website, Instagram, Google.
BR-20	Mobile numbers must be Sri Lankan (`07x` or `+947x` , 10 digits).	Validate by the tenant's country, allow international numbers for visitors.
BR-21	A waitlisted customer is notified and must confirm before a booking exists.	Keep; add automatic, time-limited offers.
BR-22	Brand changes are a private draft until published.	Keep.

4.4 Issues to resolve when the prototype becomes a product

Ref	Observation	Why it matters	Resolution
PI-1	Typing any known phone number shows "Welcome back, [first name]" and offers that person's details.	It reveals who is a customer of the salon to anyone who knows a phone number.	Recognise a customer only after the number is verified by a one-time code.
PI-2	"My booking" has no access control.	Anyone holding the device, or a booking ID, could cancel.	App: signed-in account. Web guest: one-time code or a signed link sent to the booked number.
PI-3	Multi-service bookings need one professional who does everything.	A cut and a manicure cannot be booked together, which is a common request.	Offer back-to-back services with different professionals (R2).
PI-4	Hours, breaks, the closed weekday, deposit rule and cancellation window are constants.	Every salon differs.	Move all to tenant settings (BR-01, BR-10, BR-13).

Ref	Observation	Why it matters	Resolution
PI-5	No concept of branch, role, or sign-in for staff.	A receptionist and an owner see the same figures and can refund.	Roles and permissions, audit log (section 8.2).
PI-6	The customer list is derived from bookings and keyed by phone number.	A parent booking for a child, or a couple sharing a number, would be merged into one person. Reviews of competing products report exactly this defect.	Customer records independent of bookings, with dependants under one number and an explicit merge tool.
PI-7	Ratings (“4.8, 312 reviews”, professional ratings) are static.	Displaying ratings requires a real, moderated review system.	Hide until verified reviews exist (R2).
PI-8	Checkout at the salon is missing.	“To collect at salon” is reported but there is no way to record the collection, the tender, a discount or a receipt.	Add in-salon checkout to R1 (section 8.7).
PI-9	Notifications are simulated.	The reminder and confirmation engine is a core value driver and a main running cost.	Event-driven notification service with templates, channels and cost tracking (section 8.8).
PI-10	Customer bookings are limited to a six-day window.	Bridal and colour bookings are made weeks ahead.	Month calendar with a configurable advance window.
PI-11	Staff reschedule keeps the same day and professional.	Most real reschedules change the day.	Full date and professional choice for staff.
PI-12	Languages: English only.	A large part of the customer base prefers Sinhala or Tamil.	Build translation-ready from the first screen; ship Sinhala and Tamil in R2.

5. Market and competitor research

5.1 Launch market context

59.7%
Internet penetration in Sri Lanka at the end of 2025: 13.9 million users (DataReportal, Digital 2026)

30.3 m
Active mobile connections, about 130% of the population (DataReportal, Digital 2026)

~79% / 21%
Android versus iOS share of mobile usage, mid-2026 (StatCounter)

LKR 1,190
Fresha's listed price per team member per month in Sri Lanka (fresha.com pricing page)

Three implications follow. Android is the volume platform, so Android quality and small download size matter most; iOS matters for the higher-spending urban customer and for the salon's image. WhatsApp and phone calls are the existing booking channels, so the product has to work with them (links, messages, staff-created bookings) rather than expect them to disappear. And a global competitor is already priced in rupees, so the offer has to be distinct, not merely local.

5.2 Competitor landscape

Product	Model	Pricing found (Oct 2026)	Strengths	Weaknesses for our target salon
Fresha (global, sells in LKR)	Subscription plus consumer marketplace	LKR 1,790 / month independent; LKR 1,190 per team member / month. Add-ons priced separately, for example loyalty at LKR 6,050 per location / month. 20 free automated messages a month, then per-message charges. One-time fee on new clients from the marketplace.	Very broad feature set: calendar, POS, forms, inventory, gift cards, packages, memberships, waitlist, reviews	The salon sits inside Fresha's app next to competitors. Reviewers complain about extra fees, paid messaging and slow support. No salon-owned app.
Booksy	Subscription plus marketplace	About US$29.99 / month plus US$20 per additional staff member (third-party guides citing Booksy's US page). Optional "Boost": a one-time commission, reported at 30%, on a new client's first visit.	Strong consumer app, popular with barbers	Marketplace model and commission; no local payment methods.
Vagaro	Subscription plus marketplace, many add-ons	From about US$24 to US$30 / month for one location, plus US$10 per extra bookable calendar. Branded app offered as an add-on.	All-in-one, branded app available	US-centric payments; add-on pricing accumulates.
Square Appointments	Subscription tied to Square payments	Free tier for individuals; paid plans for teams	Simple, tightly integrated payments	Square payments are not available in Sri Lanka.
Phorest	Premium subscription	Quote-based	Salon-branded app, strong marketing and retention tools	Priced for established salons; the salon must hold its own Apple developer account.

Product	Model	Pricing found (Oct 2026)	Strengths	Weaknesses for our target salon
Mindbody	Premium subscription	Third-party reports: from about US$99 / month per location, with the branded app at roughly US$249 to US$299 / month extra	Mature branded app programme	Cost; fitness-first product.
Zenoti	Enterprise	Quote-based	Multi-location chains, deep operations	Out of reach for small salons.
SaloBook (Sri Lanka)	Local SaaS	Free during early access; says pricing will not be per staff member	Built locally	Early stage.
SalonApp.lk BookMySalon.lk SalonReserve (Sri Lanka)	Consumer marketplaces	Not published	Local discovery	Marketplaces, not the salon's own brand; limited back-office.
Custom builds (local agencies)	One-off project	Example: about US$900 once plus US$20 / month	Fully bespoke, salon owns its list	No product roadmap; each salon pays for its own software.

Prices are as published or reported on the dates in Appendix A and should be re-checked before they are used in sales material. Figures from third-party guides are flagged as such.

5.3 How others deliver a salon-branded app

This is the part of the plan where existing practice is most instructive, because every vendor operates under the same store rules.

Vendor	What their documentation says
Phorest	"For Phorest to build and publish your salon branded app on the AppStore, Apple requires that you have an Apple Developer account for your business." The salon must enrol as a company or organisation, be a registered legal entity, obtain a D-U-N-S number, and have a business email and public website.
Mindbody	The client creates the Apple ID and developer account, pays Apple's fees, and grants Mindbody access as a contractor. Mindbody then takes over launching, updating and maintaining the app. None of these steps are required for the Android version.
Pike13	The business must register its own Apple Developer account, enrolled as a company or organisation; the vendor cannot create it for them.
Event-app vendors (2017)	When Apple introduced rule 4.2.6, vendors either moved clients to their own developer accounts or consolidated them into a single multi-client "container" app, which the rule explicitly allows.

> **Pattern**
> Nobody publishes hundreds of near-identical client apps from one developer account. The two accepted models are: the client owns the store account and the vendor operates it; or the vendor ships one app that holds many clients. Section 7.4 applies both.

5.4 What salon owners want

Evidence	Implication for requirements
Reviews of marketplace products repeatedly cite charges on top of the subscription, paid text messages, and commission on new clients (Capterra reviews of Fresha).	Publish simple pricing. Show message costs before sending. Never take commission.
Slow or hard-to-reach support is a recurring complaint.	Local-hours support, WhatsApp support channel, and a support console that lets staff see what the salon sees (PLT-07).
A reviewer reported client records overwriting each other when clients shared an email, phone or card.	Customer records must tolerate shared contact details (CRM-04, IAM-12).
Limited control over reminder wording.	Editable templates per salon and language (NOT-04).
Reporting that owners cannot reconcile.	Reports that tie back to bookings and payments line by line, with export (REP-02, PAY-11).
New-client retention is low: one trade source puts it at about 29%.	Rebooking prompts, loyalty and win-back campaigns are revenue features, not extras (section 8.10).
Deposits and reminders are widely reported by vendors to reduce no-shows by roughly a third to a half. Measured no-show rates vary widely by source, from about 3% (Fresha, three million bookings, 2024) to the commonly quoted 20%.	Ship deposits and reminders in R1, and measure each salon's own before-and-after rate (BO-4) instead of quoting an industry number.

5.5 What customers want

Evidence	Implication for requirements
Online booking was the most preferred method (35%) ahead of phone (28%) in Zenoti's 2023 survey of 1,500 US beauty consumers; 82% want to book from their smartphone.	Booking must be complete on a phone in a few taps, without a call.
Around 40% of appointments are booked outside business hours (Zenoti); Phorest reports that only 54% of bookings happen during opening hours.	Always-on self-service booking recovers demand that phone-only salons lose.
86% want reminders by text (Zenoti).	Reminders by push, WhatsApp or SMS are expected, with the customer choosing the channel.
The ability to book online or on mobile was a deciding factor for 37%, after location (53%) and referral (51%).	Make the booking link easy to share and to place on Instagram, Google and WhatsApp (BKG-21, MKT-08).
Younger customers expect online booking most strongly (43% of 18 to 24 year olds in a Phorest survey).	The app experience is part of the salon's image with its next generation of customers.

A caution on single-salon apps

Customers install few apps and are selective about adding one for a business they visit every six weeks. The research supports online booking strongly; it does not show that customers demand a separate app per salon. The booking site must therefore be a first-class channel, and the app must earn its place on the phone with things a web page cannot do as well: one-tap rebooking, push reminders at no message cost, a loyalty card, and saved payment details.

5.6 Positioning

Where the platform should not compete

- Lowest price: Fresha is already at LKR 1,190 per team member.
- Feature count against products ten years old.
- Consumer discovery: marketplaces own that.

Where it can win

- **Your brand, your customers.** Own app, own domain, no marketplace, no commission.
- **Built for here.** Rupee gateways, LANKAQR and cash recorded properly, WhatsApp-first messaging, Sinhala and Tamil, local public holidays, local support hours.
- **Honest costs.** Flat pricing by location, message costs shown before sending.

6. Gap analysis

The table compares what the prototype shows with what established products offer, and states what to do. “Market norm” reflects the feature lists of Fresha, Booksy, Vagaro and Phorest.

6.1 Capability comparison

Capability	Prototype	Market norm	Recommendation
Service menu, search, categories	Yes, five fixed categories	Yes, with variants and add-ons	Keep; make categories editable; add variants in R1, add-ons in R2
Choose professional or “any”	Yes	Yes	Keep
Real-time availability with buffers	Yes	Yes	Keep; add minimum notice, advance window, resources
Slot hold during checkout	Yes, 10 minutes, visible to staff	Often absent or hidden	Keep. This is a quality differentiator
Multi-service, multi-professional booking	Single professional only	Yes	Add in R2
Deposit, full payment, pay at salon	Yes, fixed rule	Yes, configurable	Keep; make configurable per salon and service
Payment failure and pending handling	Yes, unusually complete	Varies	Keep as specified
Customer reschedule and cancel with policy	Yes	Yes	Keep; make policy configurable
Waitlist	Manual notify	Automatic offers	Keep manual in R1; automate in R2
Customer accounts and booking history	No (guest only)	Yes	Add in R1: required for an app
Push notifications	No	Yes	Add in R1
Reminders and confirmations	Simulated	Yes	Add in R1
Reviews and ratings	Static numbers	Yes	Add in R2; hide until real
Loyalty, promo codes, referrals	No	Yes, often as paid add-on	Add in R2
Packages, memberships, gift cards	No	Yes	Packages R2; memberships and gift cards R3
Consultation forms, patch tests, consent	Mentioned in a service description only	Yes	Add in R2
Languages	English	Many	Translation-ready in R1; Sinhala and Tamil in R2
Day timeline with drag and drop	Yes, with validation and reasons	Yes	Keep
Walk-in queue	Yes	Rare	Keep. Differentiator in a walk-in heavy market
Conflict flags instead of auto-cancel	Yes	Varies	Keep

Capability	Prototype	Market norm	Recommendation
Staff rota, time off, per-person hours	Leave toggle only; fixed hours	Yes	Add in R1
Roles and permissions	No	Yes	Add in R1
In-salon checkout, receipts, tenders	No	Yes (POS)	Add a light version in R1
Customer records and notes	Derived list; note is a stub	Yes, with photos and formulas	Proper records in R1; photos and formulas in R2
Reports and export	Yes, good coverage	Yes	Keep; add no-show rate, occupancy, rebooking, tax
Marketing campaigns and automation	No	Yes	Add in R2
Retail products and inventory	No	Yes	R3
Commission and payroll reports	No	Yes	R3
Multi-branch	No	Yes	Data model in R1; feature in R2
Branding: logo, cover, colour	Yes, with draft and publish	Limited outside premium products	Keep and extend. Core to the proposition
Dedicated branded app	The intended model	Premium products only	Deliver per section 7.4
Chat-based booking on WhatsApp	Concept preview	Emerging (AI receptionists)	R3
Operator console, billing, onboarding	No	n/a (internal to vendors)	Add in R1: required to run a SaaS

6.2 Summary of additions and changes

Add before the first paying salon

- Tenant onboarding, plans, billing, operator console
- Staff sign-in, roles, audit log
- Customer sign-in by one-time code; secure guest management
- Configurable hours, rota, leave, holidays, policies
- Real payments through a gateway; refunds
- In-salon checkout and receipts
- Notification engine: push, WhatsApp, SMS, email
- Booking history and one-tap rebook
- App build and release pipeline; store listing kit
- Privacy, consent, account deletion

Change from the prototype

- Remove unverified “Welcome back” recognition (PI-1)
- Replace constants with settings (PI-4)
- Replace the six-day strip with a month calendar and advance window (PI-10)
- Separate customer records from bookings (PI-6)
- Hide ratings until reviews are real (PI-7)
- Remove the Customer / Salon toggle: these are different applications with different sign-in
- Let staff reschedule to any day and professional (PI-11)

7. Recommended solution approach

This section answers “what is the best way to build this kind of application”. It records the approach and the reasons, at the level a business decision needs; the solution design document will take it to implementation detail.

7.1 Solution overview

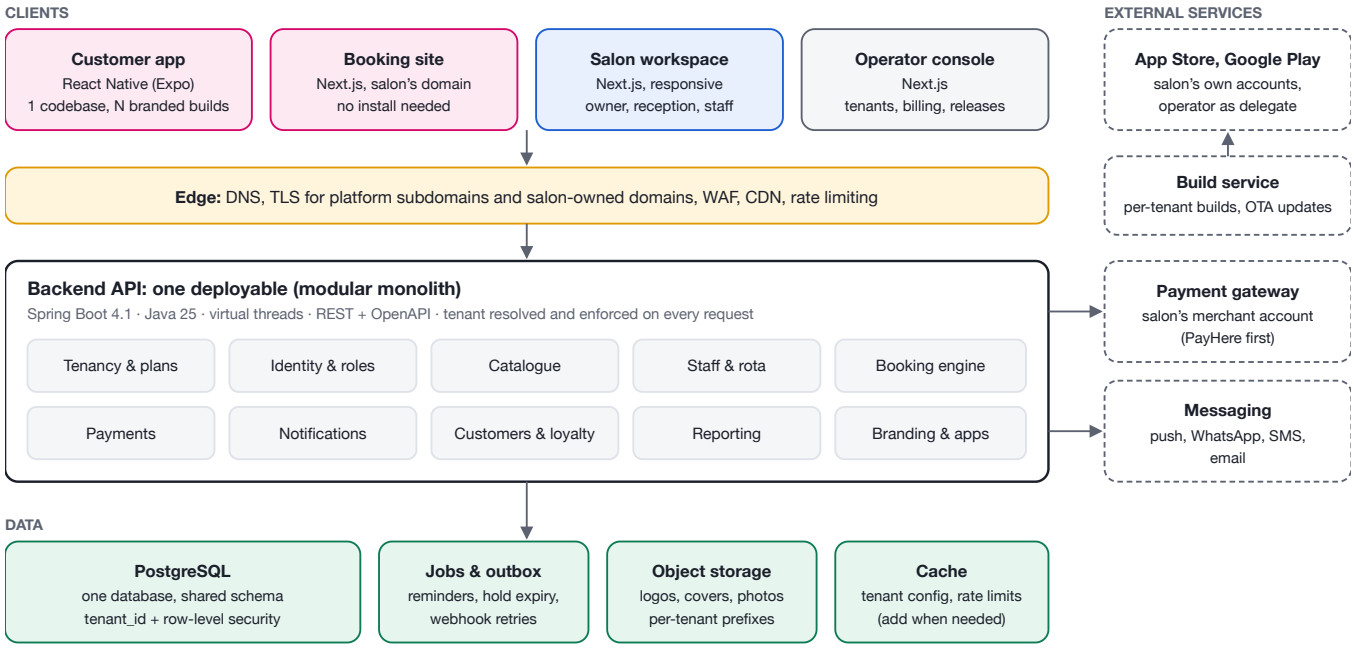


Figure 1. Solution overview. One backend and one database serve every salon; the customer-facing surfaces are branded per tenant.

Why a modular monolith. The team is small and the domain is tightly connected: a booking touches catalogue, staff, payments and notifications in one transaction. One deployable with enforced internal module boundaries keeps transactions simple and operations cheap, and leaves the option to separate a module (notifications is the likely first) when load justifies it. Microservices at this stage would add cost without adding anything a salon would notice.

7.2 Multi-tenancy model

Model	Isolation	Operating cost	Practical ceiling	Verdict
Shared schema, tenant column, row-level security	Logical, enforced by the database on every query	Lowest: one schema, one migration, one connection pool	Thousands of tenants	**Recommended**
Schema per tenant	Stronger separation of tables	Every migration runs once per tenant; catalogue grows with every salon; connection routing by `search_path`	Hundreds, comfortably	Not justified here
Database per tenant	Strongest	Highest: a database to provision, patch, back up and monitor per salon	Tens	Keep as a future option for a large chain that demands it

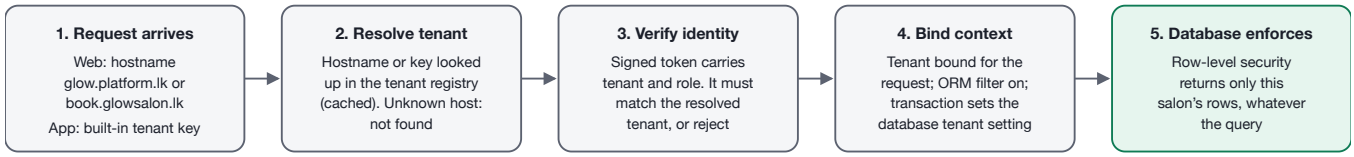
The user requirement is a single application and a single database with tenant configuration. The shared-schema model is that requirement in its most economical form, and it is how most small-business SaaS products are built. Its one weakness is that isolation depends on every query being filtered. The guardrails below remove that dependence on

developer discipline.

Tenancy guardrails (binding on the solution design)

Ref	Rule
T-1	Every tenant-owned table carries a non-null `tenant_id`. Platform tables (plans, tenants, operator users) are held separately and are not reachable with a tenant role.
T-2	Isolation is enforced twice. In the application, Hibernate's `@TenantId` adds the tenant filter to every query and stamps every insert. In the database, a row-level security policy on each table compares `tenant_id` with a per-transaction setting, with `FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY` on, so a query that bypasses the ORM is still filtered.
T-3	The application connects with a role that does not own the tables and cannot bypass row-level security. Migrations run under a different role.
T-4	The tenant setting is applied per transaction (`set_config(…, true)`), never per session, so a pooled connection cannot carry one salon's context into another salon's request.
T-5	The tenant is derived on the server from the hostname or the signed token. A tenant identifier sent by the client is never trusted on its own; where both are present they must match.
T-6	Unique constraints, foreign keys and indexes include `tenant_id`. A reference to another tenant's row is impossible by construction.
T-7	Background jobs run one tenant at a time with an explicit context. A job without a tenant context can read nothing.
T-8	Caches, file paths, search indexes and log entries are keyed or tagged by tenant.
T-9	An automated test suite attempts cross-tenant reads and writes through every API endpoint on every build. A failure blocks release.
T-10	Operator access to tenant data is a deliberate, logged, time-limited action (PLT-07), not a standing privilege.

7.3 Tenant resolution and web addresses



Hostnames in this figure are examples.

Figure 2. How every request is tied to exactly one salon.

Address type	Example	How it works	Plan
Platform subdomain	`glow.platform.lk`	One wildcard DNS record and wildcard certificate cover every salon. Created automatically at onboarding.	All
Salon-owned domain	`book.glowsalon.lk`	The salon adds one CNAME record pointing to the platform. A custom-hostname service at the edge (for example Cloudflare for SaaS) validates the domain and issues and renews its certificate automatically.	Higher tiers
Workspace	`glow.platform.lk/workspace`	Same hostname as the booking site with a separate sign-in area, so staff need to remember one address.	All
Operator console	`console.platform.lk`	A reserved hostname that never resolves to a tenant.	Internal

The Next.js application reads the hostname in its request proxy (the file named `proxy.ts` since Next.js 16, formerly middleware), resolves the tenant and passes it to pages. This layer does routing only. It is not a security boundary: authorisation is enforced in the API and the database, as above.

7.4 White-label mobile app strategy

The rules that constrain the plan

Rule	Text or substance	Effect on the original plan
Apple 4.2.6	“Apps created from a commercialized template or app generation service will be rejected unless they are submitted directly by the provider of the app’s content. These services should not submit apps on behalf of their clients… Another acceptable option for template providers is to create a single binary to host all client content in an aggregated or ‘picker’ model.”	Salon apps published from the operator’s Apple account would be rejected, and repeated attempts put the account at risk.
Apple 4.3(a)	“Don’t create multiple Bundle IDs of the same app.”	Reinforces the above for apps under one account.
Google Play, white-label guidance (2025)	Recommends a decentralised model in which each client has its own developer account, optionally managed by the white-label developer. Warns that under one account “policy issues with one app can negatively impact all other apps within the same account”. Requires a unique description, icon, graphics and screenshots per app.	Putting all salons in one Play account is possible but discouraged, and one violation could remove every salon’s app.
Apple 5.1.1(v)	Apps that support account creation must offer account deletion in the app.	Requirement IAM-05.
Apple 3.1.3(e)	Physical services consumed outside the app must be paid for by means other than in-app purchase.	Good news: salon bookings use the payment gateway, and no store commission applies.
Apple 4.2	An app must be more than a repackaged website.	The app needs native value: push, calendar, saved details, loyalty card.

Options

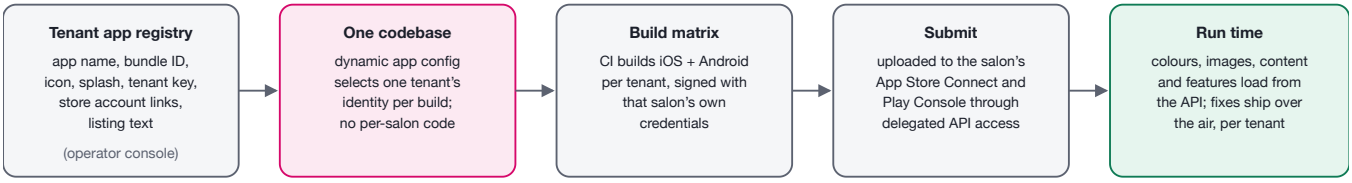
Option	Compliant	Salon’s effort	Operator’s effort	Brand result
A. Operator publishes every salon’s app from its own accounts (the original plan)	**No** on Apple; discouraged on Google	None	High, and at risk	Own listing, but operator shown as developer
B. Dedicated app per salon in the **salon’s own** developer accounts, operated by the operator as delegated admin	Yes	Enrol with Apple (legal entity, D-U-N-S, website, US$99 a year) and Google (US$25 once; D-U-N-S for organisations)	Medium: guided enrolment, automated builds	Best: salon is the named developer
C. One shared “container” app in the operator’s account. A salon link, QR code or short code opens that salon’s fully branded experience	Yes: the “picker” model named in 4.2.6	None	Low: one app to release	Store listing carries the platform name; inside, the salon’s brand only
D. Branded booking site on the salon’s address, installable to the home screen	Not subject to store review	None	Lowest	Salon brand and domain; no store presence

Recommendation

Offer **D and C to every salon from the first day**, and **B as the premium tier**. All three are the same codebase. The goal of “each salon has its own app” is kept in full for salons that choose it, and no salon has to wait for a store account before it can take a booking.

In the container app, a customer who arrives through a salon’s link sees that salon only. There is no directory, search or cross-promotion of other salons: that promise to salon owners must be written into the product and the contract.

How one codebase becomes many apps



Only what the stores require to be fixed in the binary is set at build time. Everything else is data.

Figure 3. White-label build and release pipeline.

Practice	Detail	Source of the practice
Build-time identity only	App name, icon, splash screen, bundle and application ID, tenant key, API address. Selected by one variable in a dynamic Expo configuration file.	Awaze: three brands from one Expo codebase
Run-time branding	Colour, logo, cover, texts, enabled features and policies are fetched from the API and cached. A salon can change its colour in Settings and see it in the app without a release, as the prototype’s Publish button already implies.	Prototype; common practice
Over-the-air updates	JavaScript-only fixes are delivered to every branded app without store review. A native fingerprint decides when a full rebuild is needed. One update channel per tenant app, so an update cannot reach the wrong salon’s app.	Expo EAS Update guidance
No native folders in source control	Native projects are generated from configuration at build time, so there is nothing per salon to maintain by hand.	Expo prebuild model
Unique store listings	Each listing gets its own description, screenshots generated with the salon’s branding and services, and its own privacy and data-safety declarations.	Google white-label guidance
Release in waves	Internal build, then pilot salons, then all tenants; staged roll-out on Google Play.	Standard practice
Plan for recurring work	Both stores set yearly deadlines for building against current SDK levels, and every dedicated app needs that rebuild and review. The cost grows with the number of dedicated apps; it is the main reason the dedicated app is a paid tier.	Store policy

7.5 Technology stack

Layer	Choice	Notes (versions verified October 2026)
Language	Java 25 (LTS)	Current long-term-support release (September 2025).
Backend framework	Spring Boot 4.1.x	4.1.1 is the latest stable release; the 4.1 line was released on 30 June 2026 with open-source support to July 2027 and supports Java 17 to 26.

Layer	Choice	Notes (versions verified October 2026)
Concurrency	Virtual threads enabled (`spring.threads.virtual.enabled=true`)	Since JDK 24, virtual threads no longer pin their carrier inside `synchronized` blocks, removing the main earlier caveat. See the notes below.
Persistence	Spring Data JPA with Hibernate 7; Flyway migrations	`@TenantId` for the tenant discriminator.
Database	PostgreSQL, current stable major (18 or later)	Row-level security; exclusion constraints for booking integrity; point-in-time recovery.
Web	Next.js 16 (App Router), TypeScript	Hostname-based tenant routing in `proxy.ts`; server rendering for the public booking pages.
Mobile	React Native with Expo (SDK 57 at the time of writing, React Native 0.86), Expo Router	EAS Build, Submit and Update for the per-tenant pipeline.
Shared code	One repository for web and mobile with a shared API client generated from the OpenAPI contract, shared validation and design tokens	Keeps the two customer surfaces consistent.
Edge	CDN, WAF and custom-hostname TLS (for example Cloudflare)	Salon-owned domains without manual certificate work.
Background work	Database-backed job scheduler and transactional outbox	Reminders, hold expiry, webhook retries. Add a message broker only when volume requires it.
Files	S3-compatible object storage	Images resized on upload, as the prototype already does in the browser.
Observability	Structured logs and traces tagged with tenant, error reporting for web and mobile	Needed to answer “what happened at this salon” quickly.

Notes on virtual threads

- Virtual threads suit this workload: most request time is spent waiting on the database, the payment gateway and messaging providers.
- They move the bottleneck, they do not remove it. With no thread-pool ceiling, the database connection pool becomes the limit. Size it deliberately and put explicit concurrency limits and timeouts on calls to external providers.
- Carry the tenant in a request-scoped or scoped value (scoped values are final in Java 25) and avoid designs that depend on thread-local state surviving in pooled threads.
- Monitor for remaining pinning (native calls, some file I/O) using the JDK’s pinned-thread event during load testing.

7.6 Booking integrity

Double booking is the failure a salon will not forgive. Application checks alone cannot prevent two customers confirming the same time in the same instant. The database must refuse the second one.

- A hold and a booking are the same kind of record in different states, so one rule covers both.
- A PostgreSQL exclusion constraint forbids two active records for the same tenant and professional with overlapping time ranges. The losing request receives a clear “that time was just taken” response, as the prototype already words it.
- Holds carry an expiry time. A scheduled job releases expired holds, and the availability calculation ignores them the moment they lapse.
- Payment confirmation, hold conversion and notification scheduling happen in one transaction; the notification itself is sent afterwards from the outbox, so a messaging outage never loses or duplicates a booking.

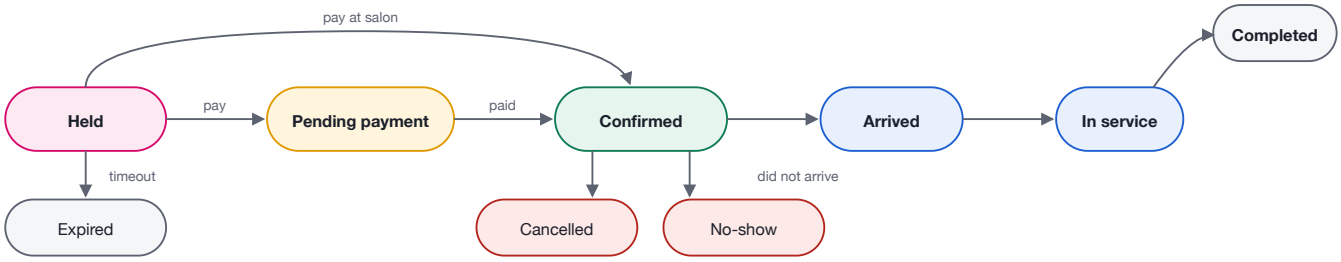


Figure 4. Booking states. Reschedule moves a confirmed booking to a new time without changing state. Cancellation carries a reason and a refund decision.

7.7 Integrations

Payments

Topic	Position
Money flow	Customer pays the salon directly through the salon's own gateway merchant account. The platform stores each salon's gateway credentials encrypted and never receives booking funds. The salon's subscription is a separate charge from the platform to the salon.
First gateway	PayHere. Published fees at the time of writing: Lite plan, no monthly fee, 3.30% per transaction with payment limits; Plus, LKR 3,990 a month and 2.99%; Premium, LKR 9,990 a month and 2.69%. Its API set includes checkout, authorise and capture, tokenised pre-approval, recurring billing and refunds. Refunds for some non-card methods may need manual handling.
Abstraction	A payment-provider interface in the backend so that further gateways (other local providers, or an international one for tenants abroad) are additions, not rewrites.
Truth	A booking is confirmed only when the gateway's server-to-server notification is received and its signature verified. A reconciliation job queries the gateway for any payment still pending after a short interval. This is the mechanism behind the prototype's "verification in progress" state.
In-salon payments	Cash, card terminal, bank transfer and LANKAQR are recorded as tender types at checkout. No terminal integration in R1.
Card data	Never touches the platform. Hosted checkout or the gateway's SDK keeps the platform out of card-data scope.

Messaging

Channel	Use	Cost and constraints
Push	Default channel for app users: confirmations, reminders, changes, offers	No per-message cost. A commercial reason to encourage app installs.
WhatsApp Business Platform	Confirmations, reminders and waitlist offers for customers without the app; later, conversational booking	Since 1 July 2025 Meta charges per delivered template message, by category and recipient country. Utility templates sent inside an open customer-service window are free; marketing templates cost the most. Templates must be pre-approved.
SMS	One-time codes; fallback when WhatsApp is not delivered	Local aggregator with a registered sender name. One-time-code traffic must be rate-limited to prevent abuse (IAM-10).
Email	Receipts, staff and owner reports	Low cost; low reach among salon customers.

Each notification follows a channel order per event (for example push, then WhatsApp, then SMS), stops at the first success, and records its cost against the salon. Whether messages are sent from a shared platform sender or from the salon's own WhatsApp number is decision D-07.

Other integrations

Integration	Purpose	Release
Device calendar, maps, dialler, WhatsApp deep links	Add to calendar, directions, call and chat from the app	R1
Booking links for Instagram, Facebook and Google Business Profile	Put “Book” where customers already look	R1
Google review link	Prompt satisfied customers to review	R1
Calendar sync for staff (Google, Apple)	Professionals see appointments in their own calendar	R2
Accounting export	Sales, tax and payment summaries for the salon’s accountant	R2
Reserve with Google and similar booking partners	Bookings from search and maps, subject to partner approval	R3

7.8 Environments and operations

- **Hosting.** A single region close to Sri Lanka (Singapore or Mumbai are the usual choices) on a managed PostgreSQL service with point-in-time recovery. Provider and data-residency position are decision D-08.
- **Environments.** Development, staging with a set of synthetic tenants, production. A demonstration tenant for sales.
- **Releases.** Backend and web: continuous delivery with backward-compatible database migrations, since app versions in the field lag behind. Mobile: over-the-air for JavaScript changes, store releases in waves for native changes.
- **API compatibility.** Versioned API; a minimum supported app version per tenant with a forced-update screen (APP-19), because old builds stay installed for months.
- **Backups and recovery.** Tested restore, including restoring a single tenant’s data to a point in time.

8. Functional requirements

Requirements are grouped by module. Identifiers are stable and should be carried into the backlog. The priority, release and prototype markers are explained in “How to read the requirement tables”.

8.1 Platform and tenant management

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
PLT-01	An operator can create a salon tenant with business profile, plan, platform subdomain, country, currency, time zone and default language.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-02	A guided onboarding checklist takes the salon owner through opening hours, services, staff, policies, branding and payment set-up, and shows what remains before the salon can go live.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-03	Starter templates (hair, nails, spa, barber, bridal) pre-fill a typical service menu that the salon then edits.	Should	R1	○ New
PLT-04	Plans define features and limits (staff seats, branches, message allowance, custom domain, dedicated app). Entitlements are enforced by the backend and reflected in every client.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-05	Subscription billing: trial period, recurring charge or recorded bank transfer, invoices, reminders for failed or overdue payment, a grace period, then a read-only suspended state.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-06	Tenant lifecycle: suspend, reactivate, and close. On closure the salon receives a full export of its data, and the data is deleted after the agreed retention period.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-07	Operator support staff can enter a salon’s workspace only through a time-limited session with a recorded reason. The session is visible to the salon owner in the audit log.	Must	R1	○ New
PLT-08	Import of customers, services and future appointments from a spreadsheet, with validation, a preview of what will be created, and an error report.	Should	R1	○ New
PLT-09	Operator dashboard: tenants by plan and status, recurring revenue, booking volume, message spend, failed payments and callbacks, app versions in use, error rates per tenant.	Should	R2	○ New
PLT-10	Message allowance and top-up per tenant, with a usage statement by channel and by message type.	Should	R2	○ New
PLT-11	Multiple branches under one tenant, each with its own address, hours, staff, service availability and prices. Reports can be viewed per branch or combined.	Should	R2	○ New
PLT-12	In-product announcements and a help centre.	Could	R3	○ New

8.2 Identity, roles and access

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
IAM-01	Customers sign in with their mobile number and a one-time code delivered by SMS or WhatsApp. There are no customer passwords.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-02	Customers can browse services and availability without signing in. Verification happens at the “Your details” step. On the web, a guest can manage a booking through a one-time code or a signed link sent to the booked number.	Must	R1	◐ Partial

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
IAM-03	A customer identity belongs to one salon. The same phone number at two salons is two unrelated customers, and nothing is shared between them.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-04	Customer profile: name, mobile, email, optional birthday, preferred language, notification preferences and marketing consent.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
IAM-05	A customer can delete their account, and request a copy of their data, from inside the app.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-06	Staff sign in with email or mobile and a password. Two-step verification is available to all staff and required for the Owner role.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-07	Roles: Owner, Manager, Receptionist, Professional, Accountant. Each has a defined set of permissions (for example only Owner and Manager can refund, change prices or export customers).	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-08	A Professional sees their own calendar and the customers they serve, and does not see salon revenue or other staff's figures unless the Owner allows it.	Should	R1	○ New
IAM-09	Sessions use short-lived access with renewal; a user can see their signed-in devices and sign them out; removing a staff member ends their sessions immediately.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-10	One-time-code requests are limited per number, device and address, with a daily ceiling per tenant and alerts on unusual volume, to prevent abuse that generates message charges.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-11	An audit log records who did what and when for sensitive actions: refunds, cancellations, price and policy changes, exports, role changes, sign-ins, and operator support sessions.	Must	R1	○ New
IAM-12	A customer can book for someone else (a child, a relative, a guest). Dependants sit under the customer's account and have their own history.	Should	R2	○ New
IAM-13	The Owner can adjust which permissions each role has.	Could	R3	○ New

8.3 Service catalogue

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
CAT-01	A service has a name, description, category, price, duration, buffer, optional image, and a setting for whether it can be booked online.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
CAT-02	Categories are defined and ordered by the salon.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
CAT-03	A service can have variants with their own price and duration (for example by hair length), and can display a "from" price.	Should	R1	○ New
CAT-04	Changes to price, duration or buffer apply to future bookings only. Existing bookings keep the terms they were booked on.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
CAT-05	Tax and service charge settings per tenant, with prices shown to customers inclusive of them.	Must	R1	○ New
CAT-06	"Popular" services on the home screen are chosen by the salon or derived from booking volume.	Should	R1	◐ Partial
CAT-07	Add-ons that can be attached to a service at booking (for example a treatment).	Should	R2	○ New
CAT-08	A professional can have their own price or duration for a service (for example a senior stylist).	Should	R2	○ New

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
CAT-09	A service can require a resource such as a chair, room or basin, and availability respects the number of each.	Should	R2	○ New
CAT-10	Packages that combine services at a set price, and courses of several sessions.	Should	R2	○ New
CAT-11	Service flags: patch test required, consultation required, custom deposit, minimum notice, staff-only (not bookable online).	Should	R2	○ New
CAT-12	Processing time inside a service (for example colour developing) during which the professional can serve another customer.	Could	R3	○ New

8.4 Staff and rota

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
STF-01	Staff profile: name, photo, title, short biography, the services they perform, and whether they are shown for online booking.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
STF-02	Working hours per person per weekday, with breaks, and overrides for specific dates.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
STF-03	Leave and time off. Existing bookings in the period are kept and flagged for action; none are cancelled automatically.	Must	R1	● Yes
STF-04	Salon opening hours, special closures and public holidays. A Sri Lankan holiday calendar, including Poya days, is supplied as a preset the salon can accept or edit.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
STF-05	Blocked time on a professional's calendar (training, errands) with a label.	Must	R1	○ New
STF-06	A "my day" view for professionals on their phone: upcoming appointments, customer notes, mark arrived and completed.	Should	R1	◐ Partial
STF-07	Professional ratings are calculated from verified reviews of completed visits.	Should	R2	◐ Partial
STF-08	Commission rules per professional and a commission report.	Should	R3	○ New
STF-09	Attendance and timesheets.	Could	R3	○ New

8.5 Booking engine

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
BKG-01	Availability is calculated in real time from opening hours, each professional's hours and breaks, leave, blocked time, existing bookings, current holds and service buffers.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-02	The salon sets the slot interval, the minimum notice before an appointment, and how far ahead customers can book.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
BKG-03	"Any available professional" assigns an eligible professional by a strategy the salon chooses.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-04	Selecting a time places a hold (10 minutes by default) with a visible countdown. The hold appears on the staff calendar, is not released while a payment is in progress, and is released automatically on expiry.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-05	Two bookings or holds can never overlap for the same professional. This is guaranteed by the database under simultaneous requests, not only checked by the application.	Must	R1	◐ Partial

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
BKG-06	Booking states: held, pending payment, confirmed, arrived, in service, completed, cancelled, no-show. Each change records who made it, when, and why.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-07	A customer can reschedule within the salon's policy. Availability is checked again at confirmation, and any payment carries over.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-08	A customer can cancel. The policy and the exact refund are shown before they confirm.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-09	Policies are set per salon: deposit (percentage or amount, cap, per-service override), free-cancellation window, amount retained on late cancellation or no-show, limits on rescheduling.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
BKG-10	Walk-ins: check immediate availability, start now, book the next free time, or join a queue with an estimated wait. Confirmed bookings are never moved to make room.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-11	Staff can create a booking on a customer's behalf, recording the source (phone, WhatsApp, in person).	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-12	Calendar views: day timeline by professional, list, and week with occupancy. Bookings can be dragged to a new time or professional with validation and a stated reason when a move is refused. The customer is notified of any change.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-13	An attention list shows bookings affected by leave, closures or removed services until staff resolve each one.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-14	Booking references are short, readable and unique within the salon.	Must	R1	● Yes
BKG-15	All times are stored in a universal form and shown in the salon's time zone.	Must	R1	○ New
BKG-16	Every booking records its channel: app, website, shared link, Instagram, Google, WhatsApp, phone, walk-in.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
BKG-17	Waitlist: a customer joins for a date, time band and professional; staff can notify them when a time opens; the customer must confirm.	Should	R1	● Yes
BKG-18	Waitlist offers are sent automatically when a matching time frees up, are valid for a limited time, and pass to the next person if unclaimed.	Should	R2	○ New
BKG-19	When no single professional can perform all chosen services, the engine offers consecutive appointments with different professionals as one booking.	Should	R2	◐ Partial
BKG-20	Customer risk rules: after a set number of no-shows, full prepayment is required, or online booking is blocked.	Should	R2	○ New
BKG-21	Recurring appointments (for example every four weeks).	Could	R3	○ New
BKG-22	Group bookings (for example a bridal party) across several professionals.	Could	R3	○ New
BKG-23	Services at the customer's location with travel time and an address.	Could	R3	○ New

8.6 Customer app and booking site

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
APP-01	Branded home: cover, logo, name, location, opening status and hours, popular services, and the next appointment when there is one.	Must	R1	● Yes

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
APP-02	The five-step booking flow as prototyped (services, professional, time, details, payment) with a progress indicator and a persistent summary of price and duration.	Must	R1	• Yes
APP-03	My bookings: upcoming and past appointments, with reschedule, cancel and “book again”.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
APP-04	Push notifications for confirmations, reminders, changes and waitlist offers, with preferences per type.	Must	R1	○ New
APP-05	Add to the device calendar, directions to the salon, call and WhatsApp the salon.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
APP-06	The same booking flow is available on the salon’s web address without installing anything. Links open the app when it is installed.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
APP-07	All text is held in translation files from the first release. The customer can choose a language where the salon has enabled more than one.	Must	R1	○ New
APP-08	Clear states for slow or lost connections. A payment is never submitted twice, and the customer is told what happened and what to do.	Must	R1	• Yes
APP-09	Terms, privacy notice and cancellation policy are available before payment, and consent is recorded.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
APP-10	Accessibility: screen-reader labels, support for larger text, sufficient contrast including on the salon’s brand colour, and touch targets of adequate size.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
APP-11	A minimum supported version can be set; older versions show an update prompt. A maintenance message can be shown.	Must	R1	○ New
APP-12	Sinhala and Tamil translations of the app; salons can enter their service names and descriptions in each language.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-13	Reviews: after a completed visit the customer can rate the visit and the professional. The salon can reply. Only verified visits can review.	Should	R2	◐ Partial
APP-14	Favourites: preferred professional and usual services, offered first when booking.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-15	Loyalty card showing points or stamps and available rewards.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-16	Offers and promo codes applied at booking.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-17	Gallery of the salon’s work and professional profiles.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-18	Consultation and consent forms completed before the appointment (allergies, patch test, medical notes).	Should	R2	○ New
APP-19	Saved payment method for faster checkout, stored by the gateway as a token.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-20	Branch selection where the salon has more than one.	Should	R2	○ New
APP-21	Purchase of packages and gift cards; balances visible in the app.	Could	R3	○ New
APP-22	Pay the remaining balance and add a tip from the app after the visit.	Could	R3	○ New

8.7 Payments, checkout and refunds

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
PAY-01	At booking the customer can pay a deposit, pay in full, or pay at the salon. The salon chooses which options are offered, overall and per service.	Must	R1	• Yes

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
PAY-02	Online payments go through the salon's own gateway merchant account. The first supported gateway is PayHere; the design allows more to be added.	Must	R1	○ New
PAY-03	A booking is confirmed on the gateway's verified server notification, not on what the customer's device reports.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
PAY-04	Outcomes are handled as prototyped: success, failure (slot stays held), cancelled by the customer, and verification pending with a status check. Repeated notifications never create a second booking or charge.	Must	R1	● Yes
PAY-05	Refunds, full or partial, are issued through the gateway where it supports them and otherwise recorded as manual. States: processing, refunded, failed, with retry.	Must	R1	● Yes
PAY-06	In-salon checkout: settle the balance, add or remove services, apply a discount with a reason, record the tender (cash, card terminal, bank transfer, LANKAQR), and issue a receipt by WhatsApp, SMS or email.	Must	R1	○ New
PAY-07	Receipts and invoices are numbered per salon and show tax and service charge lines.	Must	R1	○ New
PAY-08	Gateway credentials are entered by the Owner, stored encrypted, and tested with a trial transaction before online payment is switched on.	Must	R1	○ New
PAY-09	A payment link can be sent for a staff-created booking so that a deposit can be taken for phone and WhatsApp bookings.	Should	R2	○ New
PAY-10	Day-end summary by tender and by staff member, with expected cash.	Should	R2	○ New
PAY-11	Reconciliation: gateway settlements matched to bookings, with differences listed.	Should	R2	○ New
PAY-12	Late-cancellation and no-show fees charged to a saved payment method, where the customer agreed to this at booking.	Should	R2	○ New
PAY-13	Tips, recorded per professional.	Could	R3	○ New
PAY-14	Additional gateways and wallets.	Could	R3	○ New

8.8 Notifications and messaging

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
NOT-01	Notifications are sent for: booking confirmed, payment received, payment failed, reminder, rescheduled, cancelled, waitlist time available, refund processed.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
NOT-02	Channels: push, WhatsApp, SMS and email. Each event has a channel order with fallback, and stops at the first successful delivery.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
NOT-03	Reminder timing is set by the salon (for example the day before and two hours before). Reminders include links to confirm, reschedule or cancel.	Must	R1	○ New
NOT-04	Message templates are editable per salon and per language within approved structures, and carry the salon's name.	Must	R1	○ New
NOT-05	Every message is logged with channel, status and cost. Cost is attributed to the salon.	Must	R1	○ New
NOT-06	Customers control which messages they receive and by which channel. Marketing messages require recorded consent and always include a way to opt out. Quiet hours are respected.	Must	R1	○ New

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
NOT-07	Staff notifications: new booking, cancellation, booking needing attention, and a daily agenda.	Should	R1	◐ Partial
NOT-08	A notification centre in the workspace and in the app.	Should	R1	◐ Partial
NOT-09	Review request after a completed visit.	Should	R2	○ New
NOT-10	Conversational booking on WhatsApp as previewed in the prototype: the customer asks, the system offers times and sends a secure link that holds the slot.	Could	R3	◐ Partial
NOT-11	A shared inbox for staff to reply to customer messages.	Could	R3	○ New

8.9 Customer records

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
CRM-01	A customer record with contact details, visits, total spend, no-shows, upcoming appointments and preferred professional.	Must	R1	● Yes
CRM-02	Customer records exist independently of bookings. Two people can share a phone number; duplicates are merged only by a deliberate staff action that can be reviewed.	Must	R1	○ New
CRM-03	Free-text notes on a customer, with author and date.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
CRM-04	A register of consents: what the customer agreed to, when, and through which channel.	Must	R1	○ New
CRM-05	Export of the customer list by authorised roles, recorded in the audit log.	Must	R1	○ New
CRM-06	Structured records: allergies, patch-test dates, colour formulas, before and after photos, visible by role.	Should	R2	○ New
CRM-07	Tags and segments such as new, regular, lapsed, high-value, frequent no-show.	Should	R2	○ New
CRM-08	Block a customer from online booking.	Should	R2	○ New

8.10 Marketing and loyalty

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
MKT-01	Each salon has a shareable booking link and QR code for the booking site and the app, suitable for Instagram, Google Business Profile, WhatsApp and printed material.	Must	R1	○ New
MKT-02	A prompt to leave a Google review can be sent after a visit.	Should	R1	○ New
MKT-03	Automated messages: rebooking reminder a set number of weeks after a service, win-back for lapsed customers, birthday greeting.	Should	R2	○ New
MKT-04	Campaigns to a customer segment by push, WhatsApp or SMS, with the audience size and cost shown before sending.	Should	R2	○ New
MKT-05	Promo codes and time-limited offers, including quieter-time pricing.	Should	R2	○ New
MKT-06	Loyalty: points or a stamp card, with rewards redeemed at checkout.	Should	R2	○ New
MKT-07	Referral rewards for the referrer and the new customer.	Could	R3	○ New
MKT-08	Memberships and prepaid credit.	Could	R3	○ New

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
MKT-09	Gift cards sold online and in the salon.	Could	R3	○ New

8.11 Reports

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
REP-01	Today view: appointments, amount collected, amount to collect, walk-in queue.	Must	R1	● Yes
REP-02	Period reports for today, 7 days, 30 days and a custom range, compared with the previous period, with download.	Must	R1	● Yes
REP-03	Breakdowns by booking source, service, professional and day.	Must	R1	● Yes
REP-04	Completed, cancelled and no-show counts and rates.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
REP-05	Share of bookings made online, occupancy by professional, rebooking rate, new versus returning customers.	Should	R2	○ New
REP-06	Financial reports: sales by tender, tax, discounts, refunds, outstanding balances.	Should	R2	◐ Partial
REP-07	Combined and per-branch reporting.	Should	R2	○ New
REP-08	Staff performance and commission.	Should	R3	○ New
REP-09	Scheduled report by email to the owner.	Could	R3	○ New

8.12 Branding, web addresses and white-label apps

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
BRD-01	Brand settings: salon name, tagline, logo, cover photo and brand colour, with a live preview. Changes remain a draft until published. Text colour on the brand colour is chosen automatically for contrast.	Must	R1	● Yes
BRD-02	Business profile: address and map position, phone, WhatsApp number, social links, opening hours, description.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
BRD-03	Every salon receives a platform subdomain with a secure certificate at onboarding.	Must	R1	○ New
BRD-04	Branding, content and enabled features are delivered to the app and site from the API, so that publishing a brand change does not require an app release.	Must	R1	◐ Partial
BRD-05	A dedicated app per salon can be produced from the shared codebase with its own name, icon, splash screen, identifiers and store listings, published in the salon's own developer accounts.	Must	R1	○ New
BRD-06	An automated pipeline builds, signs and submits each salon's app from a tenant app registry, and can deliver JavaScript-only updates over the air to each app separately.	Must	R1	○ New
BRD-07	A store listing kit per salon: description, keywords, screenshots rendered with the salon's branding and services, privacy and data-safety answers.	Must	R1	○ New
BRD-08	A developer-account onboarding guide and tracker for each salon: Apple and Google enrolment, D-U-N-S, granting access to the operator, renewal dates.	Must	R1	○ New
BRD-09	A shared container app in the operator's store accounts. A salon's link, QR code or short code opens that salon's branded experience, and no other salon is shown or suggested.	Should	R1	○ New

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
BRD-10	Receipts and messages carry the salon’s name and, where the channel allows, its logo and colour.	Should	R1	○ New
BRD-11	A salon can connect a domain it owns: the workspace gives the DNS record to add, verifies it, and issues the certificate automatically.	Should	R2	○ New
BRD-12	Links on the salon’s domain open its dedicated app when installed; the booking site shows an install prompt.	Should	R2	○ New
BRD-13	The operator console shows, for every salon app, the store status, live version, pending reviews and expiring credentials.	Should	R2	○ New

8.13 Retail and inventory

ID	Requirement	Priority	Release	In prototype
INV-01	A product catalogue; products can be sold at checkout.	Could	R3	○ New
INV-02	Stock levels, low-stock alerts and stock adjustments.	Could	R3	○ New
INV-03	Recording of products used in services.	Could	R3	○ New

9. Non-functional requirements

Ref	Area	Requirement	Target
NFR-01	Tenant isolation	No request can read or change another tenant's data, including through search, reports, exports, files and caches.	Enforced per section 7.2; automated cross-tenant tests on every build
NFR-02	Availability	Booking, calendar and checkout functions are available during trading hours and beyond.	99.9% a month; planned maintenance outside 07:00 to 22:00 local time
NFR-03	Performance	Screens respond quickly on mid-range Android phones and mobile data.	Availability search under 500 ms at the 95th percentile; other reads under 300 ms; app cold start under 3 s
NFR-04	Capacity	The design supports growth without re-architecture.	Planning assumption: 2,000 tenants, 20 staff each at the top end, 5 million bookings a year
NFR-05	Concurrency	Simultaneous attempts on one slot produce exactly one booking.	Verified by load test before each major release
NFR-06	Recovery	Data can be restored after loss or error, for the platform or for one tenant.	Recovery point 15 minutes or better; recovery time 4 hours; restore tested quarterly
NFR-07	Security	Encryption in transit and at rest; secrets and gateway credentials encrypted with managed keys; least-privilege access; dependency and image scanning.	OWASP ASVS level 2 as the reference; independent penetration test before public launch and yearly
NFR-08	Authentication	Strong password policy and two-step verification for staff; rate limiting on sign-in and one-time codes.	Per IAM-06, IAM-10
NFR-09	Privacy	Personal data is collected for stated purposes, with consent recorded, retention periods defined, and deletion and export supported.	Per section 10
NFR-10	Auditability	Sensitive actions are logged immutably with actor, time, tenant and before-and-after values.	Retained 24 months
NFR-11	Payments integrity	No card data stored or processed by the platform. Every payment event is idempotent and traceable to a gateway reference.	Hosted checkout or gateway SDK only
NFR-12	Accessibility	Customer surfaces and workspace meet recognised accessibility criteria.	WCAG 2.2 level AA as the reference
NFR-13	Localisation	Languages, currency, number and date formats, time zone, tax labels and phone formats are configuration, not code.	English, Sinhala, Tamil; LKR default
NFR-14	Compatibility	The app supports current and recent operating-system versions and small Android devices.	Android 8 and later; iOS 16 and later (confirm against usage data); app download under 40 MB
NFR-15	Resilience	A failure of a messaging or payment provider degrades one function, not the system; work is retried.	Outbox with retry; timeouts and circuit breakers on every external call
NFR-16	Observability	Every log line, trace and error carries the tenant, and operators can see health per tenant.	Alerting on error rate, payment callback failures, message failures, job delays

Ref	Area	Requirement	Target
NFR-17	Maintainability	No per-tenant code or branches. Tenant differences are configuration and entitlements.	Enforced by code review and architecture tests
NFR-18	Releasability	Backend and web are deployable at any time without downtime; older app versions keep working.	Backward-compatible API and migrations; minimum-version control
NFR-19	Data portability	A salon can export its customers, bookings, services and payments in an open format at any time.	CSV or spreadsheet export
NFR-20	Supportability	Support staff can reproduce what a salon or customer sees without asking for passwords.	Per PLT-07

10. Data, privacy and compliance

10.1 Principal data

Entity	Holds	Scope
Tenant, plan, subscription, invoice	The salon as a customer of the platform; what it has bought; billing history	Platform
Tenant domain, tenant app	Web addresses; each app's identifiers, store account links, versions and credentials references	Platform
Brand, business profile, policies	What the prototype's `brand.json` holds, plus address, hours, deposit and cancellation rules	Tenant
Branch	Location, hours, contact	Tenant
Staff member, role, working hours, time off	Who works when, and what they may do	Tenant
Service, category, variant, add-on, package	The menu	Tenant
Customer, dependant, consent, note	The salon's customer list	Tenant
Booking, booking item, hold, status history	The appointment and its trail	Tenant
Waitlist entry, walk-in queue entry	Demand not yet scheduled	Tenant
Payment, refund, receipt, tender	Money in and out, with gateway references	Tenant
Notification, template, delivery log	What was sent, how, with what result and cost	Tenant
Review, loyalty account, promotion	Retention features	Tenant
Audit event	Who did what	Tenant, plus a platform log

10.2 Who is responsible for personal data

- For customer data (names, numbers, visit history, notes), the **salon decides the purposes** and the platform processes it on the salon's behalf. The contract with each salon must include data-processing terms that say so.
- For salon account, staff sign-in and billing data, the **platform is responsible** in its own right.
- A salon's customer list is that salon's asset. The platform does not use it to market other salons, and does not combine customers across salons (IAM-03). This is both a privacy position and the commercial promise in section 5.6.

10.3 Sri Lanka's Personal Data Protection Act

> **Status at the time of writing**
>
> The Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022 was amended by Act No. 22 of 2025, passed in October 2025. The Data Protection Authority is established. The amendment removed the fixed commencement timetable, and sources from mid-2026 report that the core obligations on controllers and processors were still awaiting a commencement order. The position may have changed; legal counsel should confirm it before launch.

The prudent course is to build for the Act now, since the obligations are known and are far cheaper to design in than to retrofit:

Obligation area	What the product does
Lawful basis and consent	Consent captured and recorded for marketing (CRM-04); transactional messages separated from marketing (NOT-06).
Purpose limitation and minimisation	Only name and mobile number are mandatory to book. Birthday, email and notes are optional.
Rights of the individual	Access, correction, deletion and export from the app and on request through the salon (IAM-05).
Security	Section 9: isolation, encryption, access control, audit.
Retention	Defined periods per data type; automatic anonymisation of inactive customers after the period the salon sets.
Breach handling	Detection, an internal runbook, and the means to identify affected tenants and individuals quickly.
Processor terms	Data-processing agreement with every salon; list of sub-processors (hosting, messaging, gateway).
Cross-border transfer	Hosting outside Sri Lanka is to be assessed against the Act's transfer rules (D-08).
Sensitive data	Allergy and health notes in consultation forms (R2) need explicit consent and tighter role access.

10.4 App store compliance checklist

Requirement	How it is met
Template apps submitted by the content provider (Apple 4.2.6)	Dedicated apps are published in the salon's own developer account (BRD-05, BRD-08). The shared app follows the permitted container model (BRD-09).
Unique listings (Google white-label guidance)	Listing kit generates distinct descriptions and screenshots per salon (BRD-07).
More than a website (Apple 4.2)	Push, calendar, saved details, loyalty card, offline-tolerant states.
Account deletion in the app (Apple 5.1.1(v))	IAM-05.
Browse without sign-in where possible (Apple 5.1.1(v))	IAM-02: sign-in only at the details step.
Payment for physical services outside in-app purchase (Apple 3.1.3(e))	Gateway checkout; no store commission.
Third-party sign-in rules (Apple 4.8)	Not triggered: sign-in uses the platform's own one-time-code system only.
Privacy declarations (Apple privacy labels, Google data safety)	Maintained centrally and applied to every listing.
Reviewer access	A demonstration salon and test sign-in are supplied with every submission.

Requirement	How it is met
Yearly SDK and target-level deadlines	Scheduled rebuild of every dedicated app (section 7.4).

10.5 Other regulatory points to confirm

Topic	Question for the adviser	Why
Payments	Does any part of the money flow make the platform a payment intermediary under Central Bank rules?	The recommended model (salon's own merchant account) is intended to avoid this; confirm it does.
Messaging	Sender-name registration and content rules for commercial SMS; WhatsApp Business verification.	Lead time before launch; affects template wording.
Tax	Treatment of subscription fees and of pass-through charges (messages, store fees); invoice format.	Pricing and invoicing design.
Consumer terms	Wording of cancellation and deposit terms shown to customers; who is the contracting party.	The salon contracts with the customer; the platform's terms must say so.
Store agreements	Each salon accepts Apple's and Google's developer agreements in its own name.	Needs to be explained during sales.

11. Commercial model

This section is a hypothesis to test with pilot salons, not a price list.

11.1 Reference points

Reference	Figure	What it tells us
Fresha in Sri Lanka	LKR 1,190 per team member a month; a five-person salon is about LKR 5,950 a month before add-ons. Loyalty add-on LKR 6,050 per location a month.	The price a salon owner will compare against. The add-ons show where the perceived extras are.
Booksy (US)	About US$29.99 a month plus US$20 per additional staff member	Per-staff pricing is the norm, and is disliked by growing salons.
SaloBook (Sri Lanka)	Free in early access; states there will be no per-staff pricing	A local entrant is positioning on flat pricing.
Mindbody branded app	Reported at about US$249 to US$299 a month on top of the subscription	A dedicated app is priced as a premium item everywhere.
Local custom build	About US$900 once plus US$20 a month	What a salon pays for a one-off site with booking.
Apple and Google fees	US$99 a year; US$25 once	Paid by the salon directly for a dedicated app.
PayHere	2.69% to 3.30% per transaction depending on plan	Borne by the salon on its own merchant account.

11.2 Proposed packaging

Tier	For	Includes	Mobile presence
Essentials	Independents and small salons	Branded booking site on a platform subdomain, calendar, walk-ins, customers, online payments, reports, push and email notifications	Branded space in the shared app
Professional	Established salons	Everything in Essentials, plus a WhatsApp and SMS allowance, own domain, reviews, loyalty, campaigns, Sinhala and Tamil, more staff seats	Branded space in the shared app
Signature	Salons that want their own app	Everything in Professional, plus dedicated iOS and Android apps in the salon's name, multiple branches, priority support	Dedicated store apps

- **Charge basis.** Flat monthly price per location in staff bands (for example up to 3, up to 10, more than 10), not per head. It is simpler to explain and removes a known irritant.
- **One-time fee** for dedicated app set-up, covering enrolment support, listing preparation and first submission.
- **Pass-through** of store fees (paid by the salon to Apple and Google) and of messages beyond the allowance, with the price per message shown before sending.
- **No commission** on bookings or new customers, stated prominently.

11.3 Cost drivers to watch

Driver	Behaviour	Control
Messaging	Grows with bookings; SMS and WhatsApp are charged per message	Push first; allowance and top-up; cost shown to the salon

Driver	Behaviour	Control
One-time codes	Attractive target for abuse that generates charges	Rate limits and ceilings (IAM-10)
Dedicated apps	Each adds builds, reviews and yearly rebuilds	Automation; over-the-air updates; premium pricing
Support	Highest during onboarding	Wizard, templates, import tools, help content
Hosting	Low per tenant in the shared model	Monitor heavy tenants; archive old data

12. Roadmap and release plan

Durations are indicative, assume a core team of about six (two backend, one or two web, one mobile, one QA, with design and product part-time), and should be re-estimated at the end of Phase 0.

Phase	Goal	Main contents	Exit criteria	Indicative
Phase 0 Foundations	Close decisions, remove technical unknowns	Decisions D-01 to D-13. Technical spikes: tenant isolation with row-level security under virtual threads; gateway sandbox; per-tenant app build and submission end to end with one test salon; WhatsApp template approval. Start the operator's own Apple and Google organisation enrolment and D-U-N-S. Design system from the prototype. Contracts and data-processing terms.	Spikes pass; decisions recorded; store accounts in progress	3 to 4 weeks
Release 1 Book and run the day	A salon can go live and take paid bookings under its brand	All requirements marked R1: tenant onboarding and billing, sign-in and roles, catalogue, rota, booking engine with holds, payments and refunds, in-salon checkout, notifications and reminders, customer records, reports, branding, booking site, customer app (shared and dedicated), build pipeline, operator console essentials.	3 to 5 pilot salons live; at least one dedicated app approved in each store; isolation and load tests pass; penetration test complete	14 to 18 weeks
Release 2 Grow and retain	Salons keep customers and reduce operator effort	All requirements marked R2: Sinhala and Tamil, reviews, loyalty, campaigns and automations, packages, forms, multi-professional bookings, automatic waitlist, own domain, multi-branch, saved payment methods, deeper reports, message allowance and top-up.	Measured gains against BO-3 and BO-4 at pilot salons; onboarding time meets BO-1	10 to 12 weeks
Release 3 Extend	Broaden the offer	All requirements marked R3: retail and inventory, commission, memberships and gift cards, recurring and group bookings, conversational booking on WhatsApp, booking-partner integrations.	Prioritised by pilot feedback	Ongoing

> **Sequencing advice**
> Within Release 1, build the booking site before the app. It exercises the same API, needs no store approval, and lets pilot salons take real bookings while the first app submissions are in review. Submit the first dedicated app early in the release, with a pilot salon, to learn the review process before it is on the critical path.

12.1 Dependencies with lead times

Dependency	Owner	Lead time	Needed by
Operator's D-U-N-S number and organisation developer accounts	Operator	D-U-N-S can take up to 30 days	Phase 0
Each pilot salon's legal entity, D-U-N-S and developer accounts (for dedicated apps)	Salon, guided by operator	Several weeks	Mid Release 1
Gateway merchant account for each pilot salon	Salon	Days to weeks	Mid Release 1
WhatsApp Business verification and template approval	Operator	Days to weeks	Mid Release 1
SMS sender-name registration	Operator	To be confirmed with the aggregator	Mid Release 1

Dependency	Owner	Lead time	Needed by
Platform domain and wildcard certificate	Operator	Days	Phase 0
Legal: terms, privacy notice, data-processing terms, salon contract	Operator with counsel	Weeks	Before pilot

13. Risks, assumptions and constraints

13.1 Risks

Ref	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
R-01	Store rejection or account action because apps are treated as template spam	High if published from one account	High	Publish dedicated apps only in salons' own accounts; unique listings; container app as the default. Section 7.4.
R-02	Salons cannot or will not complete developer enrolment (legal entity, D-U-N-S, yearly fee)	High	Medium	Booking site and shared app need no enrolment; guided enrolment service; dedicated app sold only where the salon qualifies.
R-03	Customers do not install a single-salon app	Medium	Medium	Booking site as an equal channel; give the app reasons to exist (rebook, loyalty, push); in-salon QR prompts. Track install and use per salon.
R-04	Operating many dedicated apps overwhelms a small team	Medium	High	Full automation of build and submit; over-the-air updates; registry and status dashboard; price the tier to fund it.
R-05	Data from one salon is exposed to another	Low	Critical	Section 7.2 guardrails; automated isolation tests; penetration test; logged operator access.
R-06	Price pressure from Fresha and free local entrants	High	Medium	Compete on brand ownership and local fit, not price; flat pricing; no commission.
R-07	Messaging costs exceed what is recovered	Medium	Medium	Push first; allowances; cost visible to the salon; abuse controls.
R-08	Double booking or wrong availability damages trust early	Medium	High	Database-level constraint; load tests; attention list; pilot before wider release.
R-09	Payment state errors: charged but not booked, or the reverse	Medium	High	Server-verified callbacks; idempotency; reconciliation job; clear pending state.
R-10	Gateway limitations (manual refunds for some methods, settlement delay, onboarding time for salons)	Medium	Medium	Provider abstraction; manual-refund workflow; pay-at-salon as a fallback from day one.
R-11	Data-protection obligations commence at short notice	Medium	Medium	Build to the Act now (section 10.3).
R-12	Scope growth delays the first paying salon	High	High	Hold the R1 boundary; anything marked R2 or R3 waits.
R-13	Poor connectivity in salons	Medium	Medium	Lightweight screens; tolerant states; today's schedule cached for reading.
R-14	Imported data is poor (duplicates, wrong numbers)	Medium	Low	Import preview and validation; merge tool.
R-15	A store or provider policy changes	Medium	Medium	Review policies each quarter; keep the booking site independent of the stores.

13.2 Assumptions

Ref	Assumption
A-01	The launch market is Sri Lanka, with rupee pricing and the Asia/Colombo time zone as defaults.

Ref	Assumption
A-02	The operator is, or will be, a registered legal entity able to hold organisation developer accounts, a messaging account and contracts with salons.
A-03	Salons that take online payments will open their own gateway merchant account.
A-04	The prototype represents the intended look, tone and flow, and is the starting point for design.
A-05	One backend, one database and one codebase per client type are fixed constraints, as stated by the product owner.
A-06	Technology choices are fixed as stated: React Native, Spring Boot on the latest stable release with the latest long-term-support Java and virtual threads, Next.js, PostgreSQL.
A-07	First-year scale is in the low hundreds of salons; the design target is 2,000.
A-08	Staff use the workspace in a browser on a phone, tablet or computer; no staff app is needed for the first release.
A-09	English is acceptable for pilot salons' staff and customers at launch.

13.3 Constraints

- App store policies, in particular Apple 4.2.6, are outside the operator's control and determine the distribution model.
- Local payment options are narrower than in markets served by global processors; split payments and platform-managed payouts are not assumed.
- Per-message charges make messaging a variable cost that must be priced.
- Small team: every design choice that adds per-tenant manual work is a cost that grows with success.

14. Open decisions

Ref	Decision	Options	Recommendation	Blocks
D-01	Mobile distribution model	(a) all apps from operator accounts; (b) dedicated apps in salons' accounts; (c) shared app; (d) web only; or a mix	Mix: (d) and (c) for all, (b) as premium. Not (a).	Architecture, pricing
D-02	Product name and platform domain	"COSMO" / `cosmo.lk` from the prototype, or other	Confirm availability of name, domain and store names	Branding
D-03	Who collects booking payments	Salon's merchant account; or platform collects and pays out	Salon's merchant account	Payments design
D-04	Customer identity	Per salon; or one identity across salons	Per salon	Data model
D-05	Guest booking in the app	Allowed; or sign-in required	Browse as guest; verify the number at the details step	App flow
D-06	Pricing and packaging	Per staff; flat by band; hybrid	Flat by band, three tiers (section 11)	Billing
D-07	Message sender	Shared platform sender naming the salon; or each salon's own WhatsApp number	Shared at launch; own number as a later option	Messaging
D-08	Hosting provider and region	Singapore, Mumbai, or in-country	Managed PostgreSQL in the nearest major region, subject to legal view on transfers	Infrastructure
D-09	Languages at launch	English only; or all three	English at launch, translation-ready; Sinhala and Tamil in R2	Content
D-10	Multi-branch timing	R1 or R2	Model it in R1, deliver in R2	Data model
D-11	Staff mobile app	Responsive web; or native app	Responsive web for R1 and R2	Scope
D-12	Marketplace or directory	Never; or later	Not now; it contradicts the positioning	Strategy
D-13	Support model	Hours, channels, response targets, who onboards	Local business hours, WhatsApp and phone, named onboarding contact for pilots	Operations

Appendix A. Sources

Accessed October 2026. Vendor pages state the vendor's own claims. Third-party guides are identified as such in the text.

App store policy and branded-app practice

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Appendix B. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Tenant	One salon business on the platform, with its own data, settings, branding and users.
Multi-tenant	One running application and database serving many tenants, each isolated from the others.
White-label	A product built once and presented under each customer's brand.
Row-level security	A PostgreSQL feature that restricts which rows a database session can see or change, according to a policy.
Hold	A short reservation of a time slot while the customer completes a booking.
Buffer	Time added after a service for clean-up or preparation; part of the appointment for scheduling, not shown to the customer as service time.
Walk-in	A customer who arrives without an appointment.
No-show	A customer who does not arrive for a confirmed appointment and did not cancel.
One-time code (OTP)	A short code sent to a phone to prove the person controls that number.
Container app	One store app that serves many businesses, each seen only by its own customers. Apple calls this the "picker" model.
Over-the-air update	An update to an app's JavaScript delivered directly, without a new store release.
D-U-N-S number	A business identifier issued by Dun & Bradstreet, required by Apple and Google for organisation developer accounts.
LANKAQR	Sri Lanka's national QR code standard for payments.
Merchant account	The salon's account with a payment gateway, into which customer payments settle.
Modular monolith	One deployable application divided internally into modules with enforced boundaries.
MoSCoW	Prioritisation as Must, Should, Could (and Won't for now).
PDPA	Sri Lanka's Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022, as amended.